

At the bottom of the screen, you can change your regional settings to show content from any of the regional editions currently available at Google News.

15.8 Personalized Home Page

In your mobile browser, type in <http://www.google.com/xhtml>. This will open the default Google homepage (US). Scroll down the choices till you highlight the link Personalized Home, then hit [Enter]. This will take you to the Google account login page, and you will be prompted to enter your username and password. Enter the required details, select the checkbox “Remember me”, and click “Sign in”. The mobile-supported gadgets on your personalised home page will be displayed. For example, if you’ve added Gmail and Top Stories from Google News to your Personalized homepage (via the PC), the first few e-mails from your Gmail Inbox and a list of headlines from the Top Stories section in Google News will be displayed. Gadgets that do not have mobile browser support will not be displayed.

15.9 Gmail

There are two ways to access Gmail on your mobile device—directly through your mobile Web browser, or by downloading and installing a J2ME Java application.

15.9.1 Access via Web

Do one of the following:

- Type in <http://gmail.com>
- Type in <http://mail.google.com>
- Type in <http://m.gmail.com>
- Select Gmail from the Google home page
- Select Gmail from your Personalised home page.

Note that your mobile browser should be XHTML-compliant to access Gmail. If you haven’t already saved your login information, you will be prompted to sign in with your user details.

Once signed in, you can see your Inbox with the first 10 messages, along with their subject headings. Click on any subject title to open it and read the message. You can scroll down below the messages to access other functions like Compose, Contacts and so on. The search box at the bottom of the screen also helps in locating e-mail.

As with the Web version, once you open an e-mail, it will be marked as read. Scroll down to the bottom of the message to choose any of the various actions like Reply, Forward, Move to Trash, etc.

Standard attachments viewable in a PC browser are also viewable in the mobile browser. Simply select the attachment (Word, PDF, etc.) and hit [Enter] to view it. Note that Excel and other spreadsheet attachments will not display correctly unless the format is extremely simple. This is due to the inherent limitations of the mobile browser’s display medium when it needs to display large quantities of text arranged in the spreadsheet format.

15.9.2 Access via J2ME Java Application

If you have one of the new Java-enabled (MIDP2) mobile devices, and your phone has the Verisign Class 3 public certificate with serial number 70:BA:E4:1D:10:D9:29:34:B6:38:CA:7B:03:CC:BA:BF, you can use the Gmail J2ME application. To download and install the application, go to www.gmail.com/app. To verify these details and to learn how to down and install Java applications on your mobile phone, check with your device’s user manual.

This J2ME Gmail application is much faster than going through the mobile browser. Additionally, it works exactly like Gmail and has the same look and feel, making it much easier to work with when viewing, reading and replying to emails. However, note that if you’re signed in, the application will constantly consume bandwidth, since it will keep checking your account for fresh mail. To prevent this from happening, you will need to explicitly quit the application by going to **Menu > Exit Gmail**.